

Guide Template

A starter for single-document beginner-guide PDFs — exercising every styled element so the stylesheet has surface area to eyeball.

Welcome

This placeholder guide is shipped with `guide-kit`. It exists for two reasons:

1. The build pipeline has something to render before you replace it with your own content.
2. Every styled element in `style.css` is exercised at least once, so a styling change is easy to spot when you eyeball the rendered PDF.

Edit `guide.md` to write your own guide. Run `make` to render the PDF (output lands at `build/<slug>.pdf`). Run `make verify` to confirm the committed reference PDF (`<slug>.pdf` at the repo root) is up to date with the source — a fast, platform-independent staleness check that does no rendering.

What this section is for

This is an h2 heading. If you change its color, weight, or margin, you'll see it when you eyeball the render; `make drift-canary` flags the resulting change in the rendered bytes.

And this is an h3

Used for subsections within a section. Smaller than h2, same family.

You can use **bold**, *italic*, and `inline code` in paragraphs. Lists work too:

- Unordered bullet one
- Unordered bullet two with code
- Unordered bullet three with **bold**

And ordered lists:

1. First step
2. Second step
3. Third step

Tables

Pipe tables get the template's table styling — blue header, alternating row tint, thin gray borders.

Element	Source markup	Renders as
Heading	# Title	<h1>
Callout	<div class="callout warn">	warning box
Exercise	<div class="exercise">	green-bordered box
Diagram	<pre class="diagram">	monospace panel

Fenced code blocks

```
$ make
$ make verify
$ make baseline
```

Code blocks render in a light gray panel in the theme's `--mono` font — Guide Mono, the bundled DejaVu Sans Mono, so the panel looks the same on every host.

What this template gives you

- One Markdown source, three outputs: PDF, website, slides
- Bundled fonts, so a render looks the same on any machine
- A version stamp that says which source built the file you are holding

Blockquotes

A blockquote renders with a left border and slightly muted italic text. Use it for pull-quotes, source attributions, or short asides that don't warrant a full callout.

Callouts

The template knows three callout variants.

Warning Amber background, orange border, bold-orange "Warning" header. Use for genuinely dangerous operations.

Tip Green tint with a green left bar. Use for advisory content that isn't quite a warning.

A blue accent callout has no bold header — just a light-blue background with a blue left bar. Good for mental-model notes.

Exercise boxes

Exercises render in a green-bordered box with the title strip on top.

Exercise 1 — Hello world

Run `make` from this directory. Confirm `build/<slug>.pdf` appears — that is the working render. The committed reference at the repo root is refreshed by `make release`, not by `make`.

You should see this exact text rendered in the green box.

ASCII diagrams

The `<pre class="diagram">` element renders ASCII art in a tan-bordered monospace panel, sized to its content.

```
guide.md --pandoc--> HTML --transforms?--> HTML' --WeasyPrint--> PDF
                                     |
                                     v
                               qpdf canonicalize
                                     |
                                     v
                               <slug>.pdf
```

Section after a forced page break

The `<div class="page-break"></div>` element forces a page break before this section. `make drift-canary` compares the rendered bytes against the committed reference, so this forced break is exercised by that check too.

More content here

Any text you put on this page lives on its own physical page in the PDF, separated from the prior section by the forced break.

How verification works

There are two commands, and they answer different questions:

- **make verify** — the staleness check, and the one CI runs. It compares the content hash embedded in the committed reference PDF's footer stamp against a freshly computed hash over the source files, using a single `pdftotext` call. No build, no rendering, no platform sensitivity — milliseconds, and correct on any machine. A mismatch means someone edited source and did not re-run `make release`, so the repo ships Markdown and a PDF that disagree. It names the stale file.
- **make drift-canary** — the environmental check. It builds a fresh PDF and compares it to the committed reference on two axes: PDF bytes, and the embedded-font list `pdf fonts` reports. Its target is drift that changes the render with no source change at all — a dependency bump, a rebuilt CI image — which the staleness check is blind to by construction, because `pixi.lock` is not a source file. CI runs it on every build and weekly on a schedule. There is no canonical host: the repo bundles its own fonts, so the same commit renders the same bytes anywhere. (`make verify-render` is the older, weaker form — page count plus extracted text — kept as a local convenience.)

If you change source intentionally, the workflow is: `edit` → `make` → eyeball the PDF → `make release MSG="..."` to land source + refreshed reference in one commit. (Or the manual dance: `git commit source` first, then `make baseline`, then `git commit --amend` to fold the refreshed reference PDF in. Doing it in the other order produces a dirty-stamp PDF that future `verify` runs will reject.)

Where to start

- Edit `guide.md`
- `make` for the PDF, `make web` for the site, `make slides` for this deck
- `make slides-coverage` says which chapters have no slide yet

Guide Template

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